

1938, July 18

The following is a faithful transcription of the type written original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Till we were pulling out of New Lisbon I had felt in doubt as to whether or no they'd been taking me for a venerable rabbi, or for something else more or less ideal. The coach was well filled, and the beard I carried--had carried more than 40 years--made me no doubt, at least a little conspicuous. Well, if there had been any misgivings in that direction, Fr. M. Joachim positively settled it with one happy exclamation. As we entered through the vestibule, each with a grip, he stopped as in astonishment and in a clear voice that everyone seemed expecting from one of the gray-beards, called out: "Glory be to God! Look at all the sisters." Crossing the Mississippi (at LaCrosse), shortly after, said friendly looking priest was calling attention to beauties down the River when I called to him in a half whisper: "Father; Look upstream." With that, he seemed to forget the scenery altogether and, coming up to our front seat offered me his hand, asking: "Are you not Fr. Maurice Casey?" "Why!" I answered, as Fr. M. J.'s hand raised to meet his, "This is Father Maurice." All attention seemed on the two of them. They had studied together 30 years before and had not met since ordination.

Before we knew it, we were speeding up the Minnesota side on through Redwing, where in 1880 Father Solanus saw railroad cars the first time, and Hastings, where Mother worked as a girl, till across and around the beautiful widening in the River, we watched the great red sun dip to the hills while we glided toward St. Paul and into the Union Depot. Here we met Fr. Edward--first time since his return from the Philippines. We phoned to your boy-friend of 60 years ago, Mike Costello, and my bed-fellow 10 years later when I was a "roust-a-bout" and he a boiler-maker in the Stillwater Penitentiary. Our dormitory, however, was outside the walls, so we had a "pull" of some kind. Mike is now a sergeant on the St. Paul Police Force.

Your Mildred had arranged with her friends, the Conley family, to give us (as indeed they did together with herself) an ideally pleasant little reception. She had a decidedly-choice little surprise "up her sleeve," when, after supper, she brought you to us from Seattle on the "long distance", and we all talked with yourself and Pat, and Emma and Guss--on my part the first time since the Golden Wedding twenty-five years before. We found ideal quarters in the College of St. Thomas, where Fr. Edward had been Rector before his resignation prior to going to Australia and the Philippines.